COURSE SYLLABUS: DESIGN RESEARCH METHODS

Instructor: Dr. Placeholder. Office hours: Tuesdays 14:00 to 16:00 in room 304, or by appointment.

Course Description

This course introduces qualitative and quantitative methods for studying how people use designed things. Students plan, run and report a small study over the term. Prerequisite: one prior course in design or the social sciences. The course carries three credits.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, students will be able to frame a research question, choose a fitting method, and justify that choice in writing.

Plan and conduct a semi-structured interview study with at least six participants.

Grading

Participation counts for 20% of the final grade, the two short assignments for 15% each, the midterm critique for 10%, and the final project for 40%. Late work loses five points per day.

Schedule

Week 3 covers interviews: we practise writing neutral questions and probing for detail, then run paired mock interviews in class. The midterm critique is due in week 7 and the final project is presented in week 14.

Academic Integrity

All submitted work must be your own. Cite every source and disclose any use of generative tools in an appendix to the assignment. Attendance is expected at every studio session.

Required Readings

Each week's readings are posted on the course site by Friday. Expect roughly forty pages per week and come prepared to discuss them.